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Inclusiveness

Chapter 2

Concept of Inclusion

2.1. Definition of Inclusion

- The principle of inclusion is simple.
- It is the opposite of **exclusion** and also **alienation**.
- It is the principle that says that whatever benefits accrue/ accumulate/ to members of a **society are the heritage** of all people, not just those who are **able-bodied**.
- Inclusion means that all people are entitled to **full membership** of the human family.

- Fundamentally, inclusion is the principle that:
 - We are all entitled to **participate fully** in all aspects of society;
 - We all have the **same rights** and **responsibilities**;
 - We all have something to **contribute**.
- It is the principle which demands valued recognition of all people and the entitlement of all **meaningful interaction**, involvement and engagement in every part of the complex and multifaceted societies in which we live.

- Inclusion is the **right of the individual** and the **responsibility of society as a whole**.
- Inclusion requires the **removal** of barriers and social structures which impede(restrict) participation.
- It requires **proactive** policy making, lateral thinking and on-going commitment.

- The principle of inclusion accepts **disability as human diversity**. Inclusion is not a **one-time project**, rather it is a process which is ultimately intended to pass through or achieve the following organically linked **steps or processes**:
 - Developing Inclusive **plan** or **policy**/legal **frameworks**;
 - Developing **Inclusive culture** within communities and institutions; and
 - Evolving **inclusive practice**.

- There are **three dimensions** need to be considered for the effective implementation of inclusive services that accommodate the special needs of persons with disabilities and other vulnerable groups:
 - Create **non-discriminatory** attitude within communities towards PWDs and other vulnerable groups;
 - Develop **accessible** and or **barrier** free **physical** as well as **service** environments for equal participation of PWDs and other vulnerable groups in socio-economic activities;
 - Empower **physical** and **psychosocial** capacity of PWDs and other vulnerable groups.

- In accordance with the analysis of WHO regarding environment in reference to disability, it includes both the **physical and service environments** as listed briefly below:

- Technology and product
- Natural environment and human made change to it
- Social support and relationships
- Attitude
- Policy, system and services

2.2. Principles of Inclusion

In accordance with UNESCO (2005) the following are **four** major principles of inclusion:

1. Inclusion is a process.

- It has to be seen **as a never-ending search** to find better ways of responding to diversity.
- It is about **learning how to live** with difference and **learning how to learn** from differences.
- Differences come to be seen more positively as a stimulus for fostering learning amongst children and adults.

- ❖ **2. Inclusion is concerned with the identification and removal of barriers** that hinders the development of persons with disabilities.
- ❖ It involves **collecting, collating** and **evaluating** information from a wide variety of sources in order to plan for improvements in policy and practice.
- ❖ It is about using evidence of various kinds to stimulate creativity and problem solving.

❖ **3. Inclusion is about the presence, participation and achievement of all persons.**

❖ ‘Presence’ is concerned with where persons are provided and how reliably and punctually they attend; ‘participation’ relates to the quality of their experiences and must incorporate the views of learners/and or workers and ‘achievement’ is about the **outcomes** of learning across the curriculum, not just **test** and **exam** results.

4. Inclusion invokes/ appeals/ a particular emphasis on those who may be at risk of marginalization, exclusion or underachievement.

❖ This indicates the moral responsibility to ensure that those ‘at risk’ are carefully monitored, and that steps are taken to ensure their presence, participation and achievement.

Inclusion promotes the two dimensions of inclusion, equality and equity.

Equality is equality of equals.

Aristotle defined **equality** as “treating **equal people** equally.”

Whereas, **equity** refers to the provision of special support for the ones who were (are) neglected in the participation of socio-economic activities of the society they live in.



Equality

doesn't mean



Equity

2.3. Rationale / Justification /for Inclusion

- The following rationales justify why inclusion is needed to be applied as a strategy to make the participation of PWDs and other vulnerable groups visible in all aspects of life of the society.

2.3.1. Educational Foundations

- Children do better academically, psychologically and socially in inclusive settings.
- A more efficient use of education resources.
- Decreases dropouts and repetitions.
- Teachers competency (knowledge, skills, collaboration, satisfaction).

2.3.2. Social Foundation

- **Segregation** teaches individuals to be **fearful**, **ignorant** and breeds prejudice.
- All individuals need an education that will help them develop **relationships** and prepare them for life in the wider **community**.
- Only inclusion has the potential to reduce **fear** and to **build** friendship, respect and understanding.

2.3.3. Legal Foundations

- All individuals have the right to learn and live together.
- Human being shouldn't be devalued or discriminated against by being excluded or sent away because of their disability.
- There are no legitimate reasons to separate children for their education.

2.3.4. Economic Foundation

- Inclusive education has economic benefit, both for **individual** and for **society**.
- Inclusive education is more **cost-effective** than the creation of **special schools** across the country.
- Children with disabilities go to **local schools**.
- **Reduce** wastage of **repetition** and **dropout**.
- Children with disabilities live with their family and use community **infrastructure**.
- It facilitates better **employment** and job creation opportunities for people with disabilities.

1. How do you think countries can build inclusive society
2. Do you think countries may face challenges while they try to build inclusive community? What do you think the expected challenges ?

2.3.5. Foundations for Building Inclusive Society

- ✓ Formation of mutual understanding and appreciation of diversity.
- ✓ Building up empathy, tolerance and cooperation.
- ✓ Promotion of sustainable development.

2.4.Features and barriers of inclusive environment

- Inclusive environment is characterized by the following features that revolve around the formation of accommodative and barrier free atmosphere.
- An inclusive environment is one in which members feel respected by and connected to one another.
- An inclusive environment is an environment that welcomes all people, regardless of their disability and other vulnerabilities.

Features and barriers Cont'd ...

- ❖ It recognizes and uses their skills and strengthens their abilities.
- ❖ An **inclusive service environment** is **respectful**, **supportive**, and **equalizing**.
- ❖ An inclusive environment reaches out to and includes individuals with disabilities and other vulnerable groups at **all levels of services and community life**.
- ❖ An inclusive environment is a place which is **adjusted** to individuals' needs.

Cont'd...

- ❖ It acknowledges that **individual differences** among individuals are a source of richness and diversity, and not a problem, and that various needs and the individual pace of learning and development can be met successfully with a wide range of flexible approaches.
- ❖ Besides, the environment should involve **continuous process** of changes directed towards strengthening and encouraging different ways of participation of all members of the community.

Cont'd ...

❖ An **inclusive environment** is also directed towards **developing culture, policy and practice** which meet pupils' diversities, towards **identifying** and **removing obstacles** in learning and participating, towards developing a suitable provision and supporting individuals.

Cont'd....

- Regardless of these positive features and qualities of inclusion in terms of the promotion of the issue of disability and vulnerability in public services, there are three types of barriers preventing persons with disabilities from participating in society on equal terms with non-disabled people:

1. Social and attitudinal barriers;
2. Environmental and technical barriers; and
3. Institutional barriers.

Social and attitudinal barriers

- Attitudinal barriers, including **prejudice** and **discrimination** cause the biggest problems to persons with disabilities.
- Disability is associated with **shame**, **fear** and/or pity, easily leading to **isolation** or **overprotection**.
- Disability is often also seen as a **curse** and **punishment** of wrong doing and wrath of God.

Cont'd...

- PWDs are assumed as incapable/inadequate and dependent upon others who deserve passion and charity.
- In order to avoid discrimination, the family may keep the person with a disability hidden at home.
- Negative language reflects and can reinforce prejudices.

Environmental and technical barriers

- ✓ **Environmental barriers** include **natural** or **technical** barriers that prevent persons with disabilities from participation. PWDs encounter these barriers in areas such as: **public transport, hospitals and clinics, schools and housing, shops and marketplaces, places of worship, media and communications** etc. due to the physical inaccessibility of such service areas.
- ✓ **Technical barriers** include **high steps** and **concrete platforms**, narrow entrances, **lack of or too heavy doors**, narrow / **partitions** /cubicles, lack of **light** and handrails.
- ✓ **Natural barriers** include **uneven, rough** or **steep** paths on **muddy** and/or **slippery** ground.

Institutional barriers

- Institutional barriers are related to **legislation**, **policies** and action plans.
- Even if policies and legislation take persons with disabilities into account, the challenge is that they often lack **directives**, **strategies** and **guidelines** for implementation.
- In addition, the relevant ministries/ bureaus responsible may not be **aware of these policies**.
- Consequently, persons with disabilities are frequently **left out** of planning, implementation and management of different public services.

2. Ponder on the following **quotations** and give your analysis on the messages conveyed by the quotations.

2.1. *“A negative attitude is like a flat tire. You cannot go anywhere until you change it.”*

2.2. *“Know me for my abilities, not for my disability.”*